PHASE 2 - EMPATHIZE

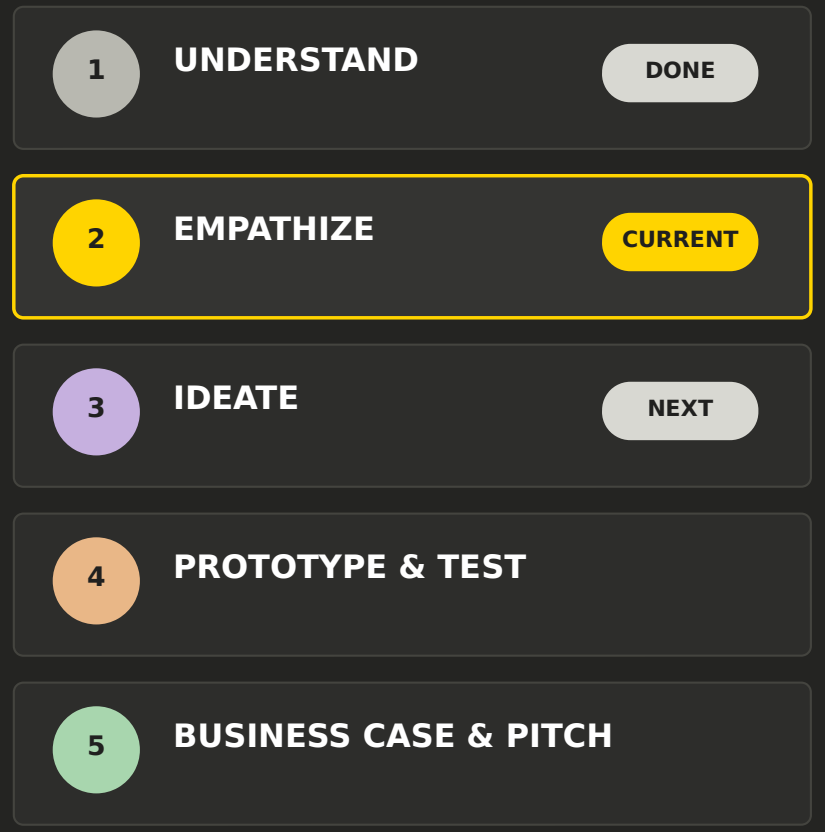
From assumptions to real evidence

Mass-Affluent Wealth Advice

We are not proving our idea. We are learning whether the problem is real.

Listen → compare → synthesize → reframe

Status: preparation is ready; real interviews and synthesis still need to happen.



Phase 2 is prepared - but not yet completed.

Five RBI preparation prompts are ready. Four synthesis prompts must wait for real interview notes.



READY NOW

4 hypotheses + pass marks
30-min expert guide
5–7 min street guide
recruitment + note templates

NEEDS REAL PEOPLE

~12 street interviews → aim ~10 in segment
1 expert as a signal
ideally 1–2 bankers too

NOT RUN YET

Pattern analysis → personas → journey map → How Might We

Prompts 2.3.1–2.3.4 intentionally wait for real notes.

Assumptions become useful only when we can prove them wrong.

The team has four core hypotheses. H1, H3 and H4 are the first priorities.

H1 Personalisation — PRIORITY

Assumption: Customers do not receive sufficiently personalised advice.

Test: 7/10 customers with advice say it was not sufficiently personalised.

H2 Knowledge & confidence

Assumption: Understanding or confidence makes investment decisions difficult.

Test: 6/10 customers say knowledge / confidence is a barrier.

H3 Digital + human — PRIORITY

Assumption: Customers prefer a hybrid journey.

Test: 7/10 prefer digital for simple steps + a human for important decisions.

H4 Advisor capacity & tools — PRIORITY

Assumption: Data, tools or preparation time limit personalisation.

Test: Most advisors / experts report these constraints.

H1 is scored only among people who actually received advice. “No advice” and “not personalised” are different findings.

Two perspectives: how the service works, and how it feels.

Expert evidence explains the system. Customer stories reveal the lived experience. We need both.

EXPERT / BANKER

30 minutes

What we need from them

1. How customers are segmented
2. What advice exists today
3. Where digital and human connect
4. What limits advisers: time, data, tools
5. Where customers drop off / go elsewhere

Signal, not proof

STREET CUSTOMERS

5–7 minutes

Who we want to hear from

1. Savings beyond everyday needs
2. Savers without a clear plan
3. People who invest with their bank
4. People who invest elsewhere
5. Mix of ages and channel habits

~12 interviews → aim ~10 in segment

Anonymous, no amounts, no account details, no solution pitch. Work in pairs: one asks, one writes exact words.

Start broad, then walk through the real advice journey.

Simple questions help the expert give facts, examples and gaps instead of abstract opinions.

1

SEGMENT

How do you segment customers - income, deposits, investments or total assets?

2

SERVICE

Where do mass-affluent customers fit, and do they get a personal adviser?

3

JOURNEY

How does investing start, and what are the main steps from interest to investment?

4

CHANNELS

What can customers do digitally, and when do they need a human?

5

GAPS

Where do customers get stuck, and what makes personal support difficult?

Close: “If you could improve one part of this journey, what would create the most value for customers?”

Probes: “Can you give a recent example?”, “What happened next?”, “How do you know?”, “Is there data on that?”

Ask for stories, not opinions about our ideas.

Understand what people actually did the last time they faced a savings or investment decision.

SCREEN	LAST EXPERIENCE	BARRIERS	DIGITAL vs HUMAN	TRUST & VALUE
“Savings beyond everyday needs or thought about investing?”	“Tell me about the last time you got advice about your money.”	“What was difficult or unclear when deciding?”	“What do you do yourself, and when do you want a person?”	“What would make your bank’s help more useful or trustworthy?”

DO

Use “Tell me about…”, “Walk me through…”, “What happened next?”

DON’T

Ask amounts, pitch hybrid, defend the bank, or turn the interview into advice.

LISTEN FOR

Confusion, delay, trust, workarounds, switching provider and emotion.

Rule of thumb: 80% listening, 20% talking. Use silence and follow interesting threads.

Keep customer evidence, expert evidence and our interpretation separate.

The aim is to learn what holds, what breaks, and why - not to “win” the hypothesis.

CUSTOMER STORY

Exact words, actions and feelings from a real recent situation.

EXPERT / BANKER SIGNAL

How the process works, constraints, data sources and operational gaps.

OUR INTERPRETATION

A possible explanation. Useful, but never label it as a customer fact.

TRACK EACH INTERVIEW

ID	TYPE	IN SEG?	H1	H2	H3	H4
E1	Expert	-	?	?	?	Y
C1	Customer	Y	Y	?	Y	-
C2	Customer	Y	N	Y	?	-

Y = supports N = contradicts ? = unclear

H1 rule: only score people who actually received advice.

One expert is a signal for H4, not proof. ~10 street interviews are directional learning, not statistical validation.

07 - AFTER THE INTERVIEWS

Real notes turn into a focused problem - then Ideate.

The remaining RBI prompts should run only after real evidence exists.

2.3.1

PATTERN ANALYSIS

Cluster repeated pains, contradictions and strong quotes.

2.3.2

PERSONAS

Describe meaningful behaviour / need patterns only if evidence supports them.

2.3.3

JOURNEY MAP

Map the real path, emotions, pains and moments of help.

2.3.4

HOW MIGHT WE

Reframe the strongest evidence-backed problem into an open design question.

Exit gate: validated / invalidated hypotheses + 2–3 insights + current journey + focused problem + one How Might We question.

The best result is not “our hypothesis was right.” It is “we understand the customer well enough to choose what to solve.”